# JUNCTION

## EUROPE’S LEADING HACKATHON ORGANIZER

hackjunction.com

# JUNCTION

## OUR MISSION

Turning complex problems into scalable reality. We exist to fuel a global community of innovators obsessed with pushing the limits of technology.

## 2025 JUNCTION MAIN EVENT

| APPLICATIONS | VISITORS | PARTICIPANTS |
|---|---|---|
| 4073 | 1800 | 1455 |
| HACKERS | PEOPLE | HACKERS |

| PARTNERS | PROJECTS | MENTORS |
|---|---|---|
| 63 | +350 | 150 |
| COMPANIES | PROJECTS | EXPERTS |

**THE LEADING HACKATHON ORGANIZER** IN EUROPE AND EMEA

**WORLDWIDE HACKATHON SERIES** LEADING UP TO THE MAIN EVENT IN FINLAND

# WHAT IS JUNCTION

OVER A DECADE OF CONNECTING AND CHALLENGING THE **BEST TECH TALENT IN THE WORLD**

**PART OF THE SLUSH ECOSYSTEM**

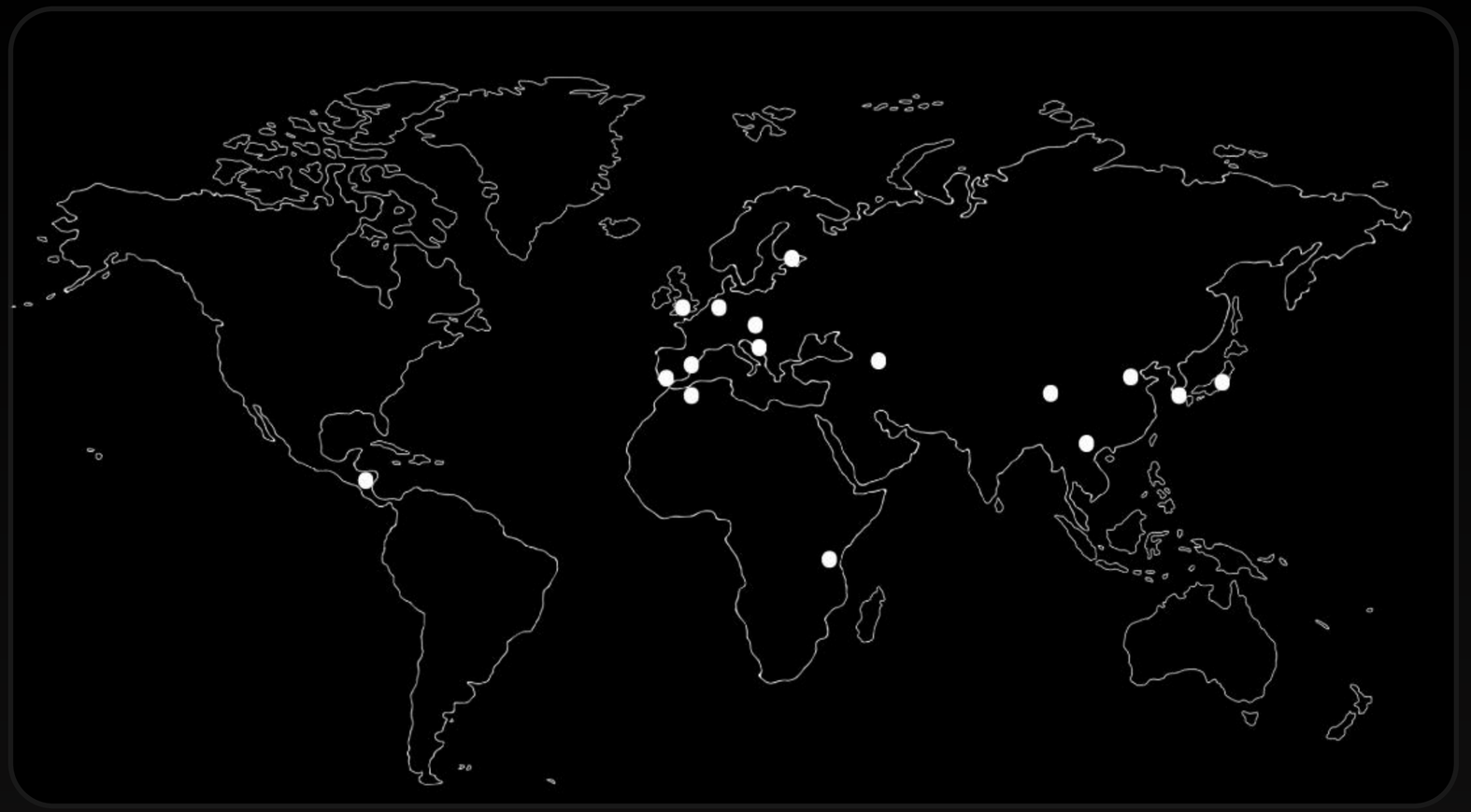
**PART OF THE NORDIC STARTUP ECOSYTEM**

- OWNED BY THE STARTUP FOUNDATION

INHOUSE BUILT HACKATHON ORGANIZING PLATFORM - **JUNCTION PLATFORM**

# WORLDWIDE EVENTS WITH LOCAL JUNCTIONX ORGANIZERS

ALL EVENTS THROUGHOUT THE YEAR
LEAD UP TO THE JUNCTION MAIN EVENT



**+25**

JUNCTION COUNTRIES

**+100**

EVENTS ORGANIZED

**+50K**

DEVELOPER ATTENDEES

# WHAT IS A HACKATHON?

“A **hackathon** is an intensive, weekend-long event where programmers, designers, and domain experts collaborate to develop innovative technological solutions for real-world business challenges presented by partnering companies.”

**… so basically concentrated unbiased brainpower of the freshest ideas and newest technology.**





# SOME PARTNERS FROM 2025













































# JUDGES, KEYNOTES AND MENTORS

2025 Main Event



**Peter Sarlin**
Co-Founder & CEO
AMD Silo AI



**Mikko Hyppönen**
CRO Sensofusion



**Petter Made**
Co-Founder SumUp
Partner EWOR



**Neil Lock**
Google
Ex Y Combinator Co-Founder



**Jesse McCulloch**
Spectacles Community Manager Snap



**Emil Sievinen**
Chief AI Officer Norrin



**Paige Bailey**
AI DevRel Lead
Google DeepMind



**Laura Modiano**
Startups EMEA
OpenAI



**Inka Mero**
Founder & Managing Partner Voima Ventures



**Ryan MacArthur**
Co-founder
Kontext.dev



**Aino Bergius**
Lovable
Ex-CEO of SLUSH

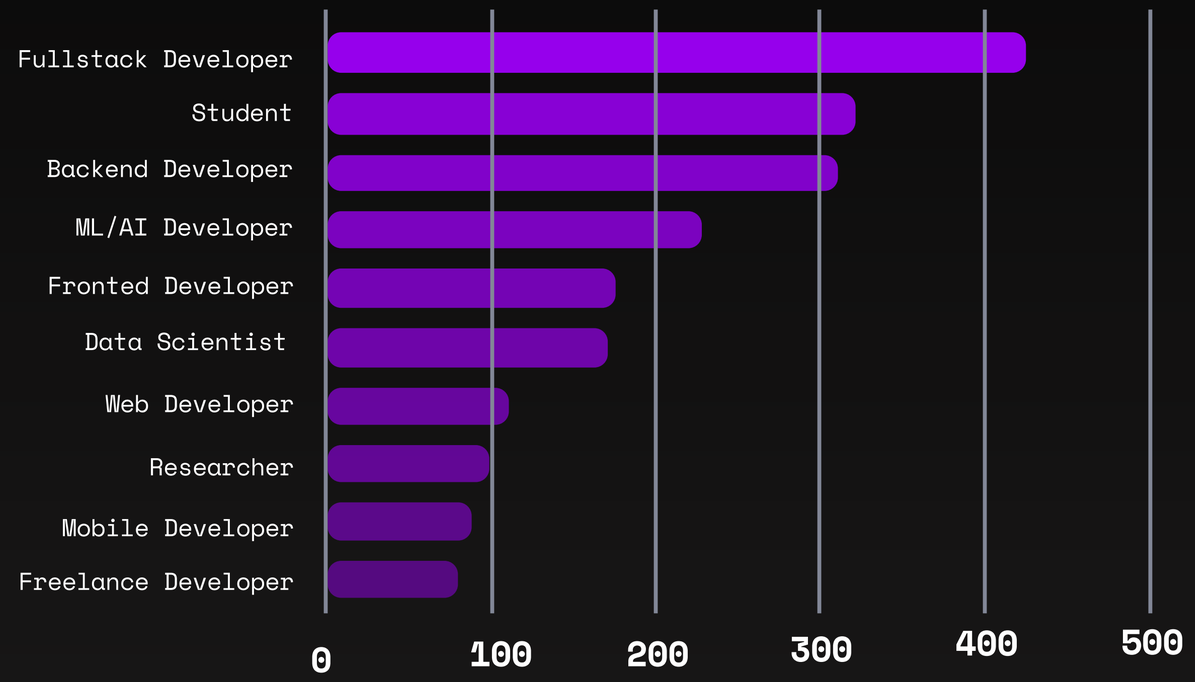


**Taavi Paananen**
Founder Supercell AI Innovation Lab
Forbes 30u30

# PARTICIPANT BREAKDOWN

Source: Junction Participant Data 2025 Main Event

## TOP 10 ROLES DISTRIBUTION




## GENDER DISTRIBUTION

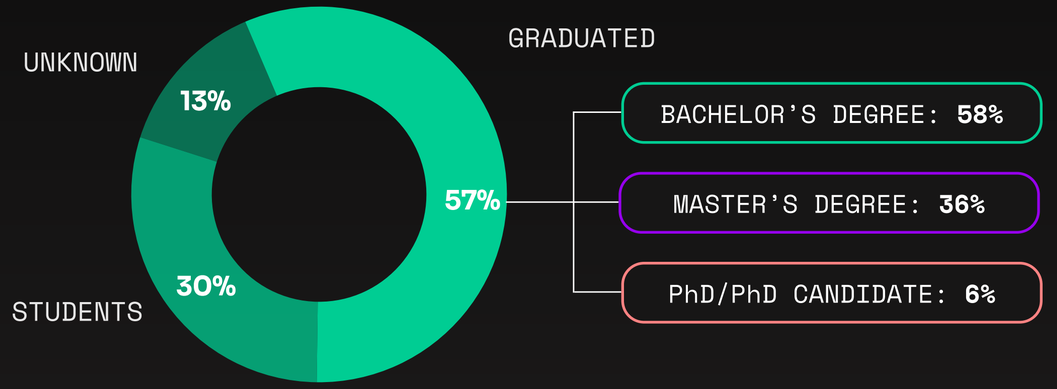



**91**
NATIONALITIES

**428**
UNIVERSITIES REPRESENTED

**40%**
ACTIVELY LOOKING FOR JOBS

## DEGREE STATUS



# UNPARALLELED GATHERING OF TOP TECH TALENT

PARTICIPANT PROFILE

**4.8** YEARS

AVERAGE PROGRAMMING EXPERIENCE

**46.2%**

PROFESSIONAL FULL-TIME ENGINEERS

**25.4**

AVERAGE PARTICIPANT AGE

APPLICANTS COVERING ALL ELITE INSTITUTIONS

Cornell University
Berkeley University of California
Yale University
Stanford University
Harvard University
University of Cambridge
UCLA
King Abdullah University of Science and Technology
University of Calgary
ETH zürich
Universität Zürich
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
KTH Vetenskap och Konst
University of Oxford
Caltech
University of Toronto
University of Helsinki
Aalto University
Tsinghua University

# PARTICIPANTS BY COUNTRY

“I CONSIDER JUNCTION TO BE THE PEARL OF THE HACKATHON WORLD.”
-Elisa, former Junction partner

“IF YOU WANT YOUNG EUROPEAN TALENT, COME TO JUNCTION.”
- Sensofusion, 2025 Main Partner

PARTICIPANT COUNTRIES



TOP 10 COUNTRIES

| | |
|---|---|
| FINLAND | ESTONIA |
| SWEDEN | ALGERIA |
| NETHERLANDS | ITALY |
| GERMANY | DENMARK |
| UNITED KINGDOM | LATVIA |

# VISIBILITY & MEDIA

SOCIAL MEDIA CHANNELS

2026 SOCIAL MEDIA & WEBSITE ANALYTICS

INSTAGRAM

+10M

REELS AND POST IMPRESSIONS

LINKEDIN

+300k

IMPRESSIONS

hackjunction.com

+100K PAGEVIEWS

ARTICLES ABOUT JUNCTION

AALTO MAGAZINE

HELSINGIN SANOMAT

TALOUSELÄMÄ

TIVI

HUFFPOST

# JUNCTION COMMUNITY CHANNELS

COMMUNITY CHANNELS



DISCORD

**2.2k**

COMMUNITY MEMBERS

JUNCTION INSIGHTS

NEWSLETTER

**10k**

SUBSCRIBERS

# WHY SHOULD YOU PARTNER UP WITH US?



## PUSH PRODUCT ADAPTATION FOR DEVELOPERS AND FOUNDERS

STAND OUT FROM THE CROWD AND ENGAGE WITH YOUR CORE AUDIENCE DOING HANDS-ON PROJECTS TOGETHER

ACCESS MULTIPLE EVENTS AND CHANNELS WITH THE JUNCTION ORGANIZATION




## ACCESS TO TOP TECHNICAL TALENT

ENHANCE EMPLOYER BRANDING

INTERACT WITH TOP ENGINEERS AND DEVELOPERS

PARTICIPANT DATA FOR RECRUITING NEEDS




## VISIBILITY IN A GLOBAL DEVELOPER COMMUNITY

THOUSANDS OF TECH PROFESSIONALS

NETWORK WITH INDUSTRY LEADING COMPANIES AND EMERGING STARTUPS

JUNCTION SOCIAL MEDIA AND COMMUNITY CHANNELS

# WHY SHOULD YOU PARTNER UP WITH US?



## GATHER VALUABLE FEEDBACK FROM THE END USER

DON'T JUST SHOWCASE, BUILD ALONGSIDE YOUR CORE AUDIENCE

LEVERAGE THE DIVERSE JUNCTION EVENTS AND CHANNELS TO CONDUCT RAPID USER INTERVIEWS, USABILITY TESTS AND SURVEYS



## RAPID PROTOTYPING AND R&D

INSTEAD OF A THREE-MONTH INTERNAL SPRINT, YOU CAN THROW A REAL-WORLD BUSINESS CHALLENGE AT HUNDREDS OF BRIGHT MINDS

WALK AWAY WITH DOZENS OF UNIQUE PROTOTYPES AND "OUT OF BOX" SOLUTIONS




## CULTURAL INJECTION

PARTNERING WITH JUNCTION ALLOWS YOUR EMPLOYEES TO MENTOR OR PARTICIPATE.

EXPOSE YOUR INTERNAL TEAM TO THE BUILDER MINDSET, SPARKING FRESH ENERGY AND MODERN WAY OF WORKING

# JUNCTION

**13.11. - 15.11.2026**

**HYBRIDIAREENA HYPE**
Vanha Jorvaksentie 3, Espoo,
Finland

**PARTICIPANTS**
1500 - 2000 Developers,
Engineers, Designers

# APPENDIX 1: FAQs

1. Schedule Example
2. Workshops & Keynotes
3. Choosing the Grand Winner
4. Choosing the Challenge Winners
5. Networking & Recruitment
6. The Challenges
7. Terminal Week
8. Junction Network
9. Challenge Workshops and Consultation

# 1. SCHEDULE EXAMPLE

The hackathon weekends includes hands-on working, workshops, demos, keynotes, networking and fun activities

TYPICAL SCHEDULE

**FRIDAY**

16:00 - Doors Open
18:00 - Opening Ceremony
19:00 - Hacking begins
19:30 - Dinner
20:00 - Workshop #1
20:30 - Workshop #2
23:59 - Draft Submission

**SATURDAY**

8:00 - Breakfast
10:00 - Workshop #3
12:00 - Keynote #1
12:30 - Lunch
14:00 - Keynote #2
16:00 - Workshop #4
20:00 - Sauna & Cold Plunge
23:59 - Draft Submission

**SUNDAY**

8:00 - Breakfast
10:00 - Final Submission
10:00 - Reviewing Starts
12:00 - Lunch
14:00 - Reviewing Ends
14:00 - Final Ceremony
15:00 - Winners Chosen
16:00 - Event Ends
16:00 - Doors Close

WHAT THE HACK HAPPENS AT JUNCTION?

# 2. WORKSHOPS & KEYNOTES

The Junction Main Event has program ranging from keynote speeches to interactive workshops

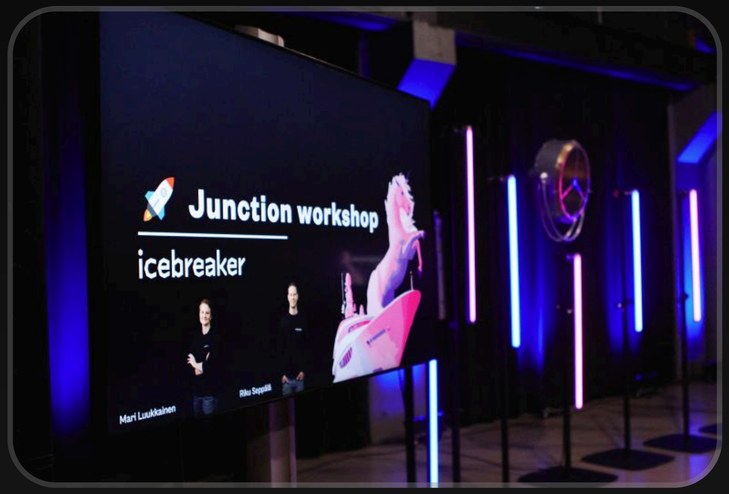



EXAMPLES

“HOW TO KILL DRONES”
- MIKKO HYPPÖNEN

“HOW TO RAISE VC FUNDING”
- INKA MERO

“USING FIGMA MAKE TO BUILD FULLSTACK PRODUCTS”
- HUGO RAYMOND



# 3. CHOOSING THE GRAND WINNER

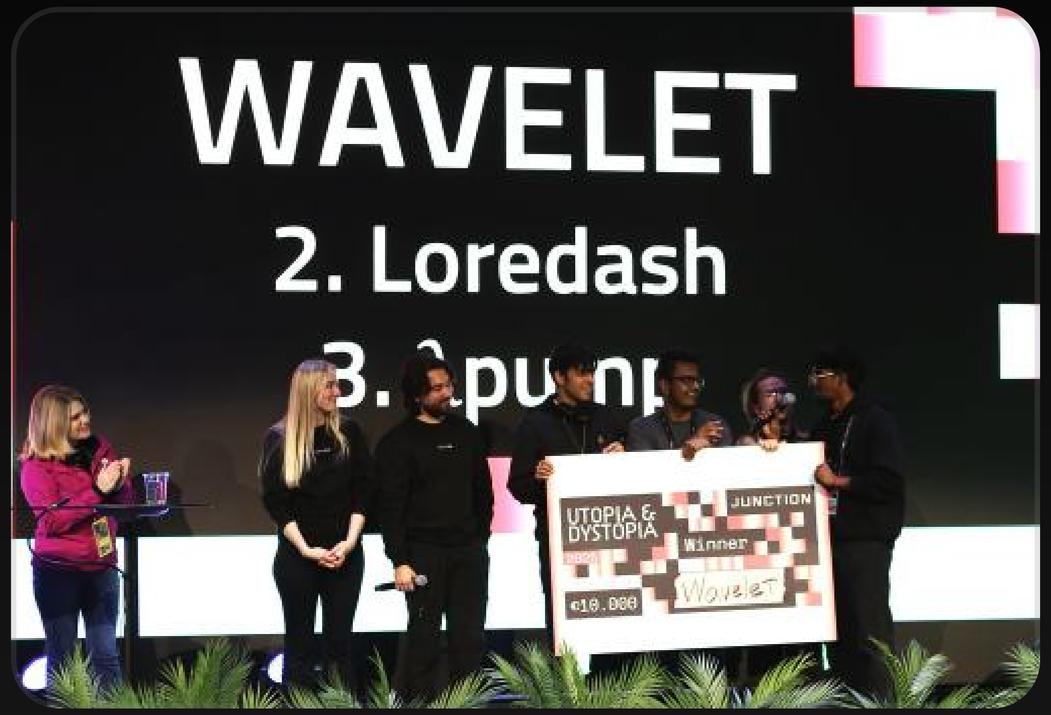
All of the teams compete for a prize pool of over 10,000 €

JUNCTION GRAND WINNER

Top 5 projects are chosen from hundreds of projects created during the hackathon with the Junction Platform and peer-to-peer Gavel Voting

The top 5 teams pitch on-stage in front of the live audience during the closing ceremony

The Grand Jury chooses the overall winning team and best project



# 4. CHOOSING THE PARTNER CHALLENGE WINNER

The Challenge Partner chooses its own prizes to give to the participants e.g. cash, iPads, Oura rings, internships

JUNCTION CHALLENGE WINNER

Junction consists of multiple different challenges provided the Challenge Partners.

The partner company mentors and provides guidance to the teams that are building solutions to their challenge.

Projects are evaluated according to the partner's own criteria. Criteria for example include:

1) Innovation, 2) Business Viability, 3) User Experience



# 5. NETWORKING & RECRUITING



Through challenges, mentoring, and networking, Junction creates opportunities for internships, jobs, collaborations and even future customers among the next generation of founders.




Partners and hackers have a weekend to share ideas, demos and learn cutting-edge tech skills together over the weekend.

# 6. THE CHALLENGES

The participants spend the entire weekend solving the challenges provided by the partners

## MAIN CHALLENGES

A Main Challenge is a flagship partner challenge at Junction, typically backed by a major company and larger prize pool. It is designed to attract a broad range of participants and focuses on solving a significant real-world problem

Main Challenges receive the most visibility during the event and often include deeper partner involvement through mentoring, workshops, and judging.

## TECH CHALLENGES

A Tech Challenge focuses specifically on building with a particular technology, tool, platform, or API. The goal is to encourage participants to experiment with and adopt the technology, often in combination with other challenges.

These challenges usually have a more technical scope and are centered around showcasing the capabilities of the partner's developer platform.



# 7. TERMINAL WEEK

During the Junction Terminal Week, i.e. the week leading up to the main event, partner companies can host relaxed get-togethers for selected participants.

Usual activities include: Pizza, drinks and introductions to the company or the challenge.

Terminal week event can be hosted online via Discord or at your chosen location. E.g. our office at Startup Sauna or partner office



# 8. JUNCTION NETWORK

As a part of the European Startup Ecosystem, Junction is part of a vibrant tech and startup network.

ALUMNI COMPANIES AND NETWORK

WOLT

SINGA

DOUBLEPOINT

AIVEN

SMARTLY.IO

SWAPPIE

SLUSH

HUUVA

VERI

ROTOMATE

SWARMIA

TAITO.AI

ADALYON

WITTYMACHINES

WAVE VENTURES

# 9. CHALLENGE WORKSHOPS AND CONSULTATION

To ensure that your challenge is relevant and formulated in the best possible way, we organize Challenge Workshops to help you if there's any doubts. Usually 1 - 2 sessions.

